

Teacher Guide — primary / module-13- indic-ecology

IKS Curriculum

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Overview

Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

Band: Primary (Grades 3–5) · **Sessions:** 10 × 30 min · **Sanskrit:** Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

Overview

Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam — “the world is one family” — from the Mahā Upaniṣad (6.71–73) anchors the Indian ecological tradition. Combined with the Pṛthivī Sūkta (Atharva Veda 12.1), Iṣopaniṣad mantra 1, and Bhagavad Gītā 3.10–14 on *yajña* as ecological cycle, students encounter classical frameworks and apply them to modern climate and sustainability challenges.

NEP 2020 alignment

- §4.6 — Integration of Indian Knowledge Systems
- §4.23 — Experiential learning (local-ecology mapping)
- §11.8 — Holistic, multidisciplinary (ethics + ecology + climate)

Key terms (this module)

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* — “the world is one family” — Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71
- *yajña* — cycle of giving and receiving (BG 3.10–14)
- *ahiṃsā* — non-violence; extended to non-human life
- *devarakāṇḍu* — sacred grove (Karnataka, S. India)
- *sthāvara-jāṅgama* — immobile (plants, rocks) and mobile (animals) life

Prerequisites

Module 2 (Panchabhūta) is recommended before this module. Modules 5 (Bindu Paddhati / dot addition) and 7 (×11 Multiplication) are useful prerequisites for Module 9 and 11.

Materials needed (across 10 days)

- Notebook + pencils per student
- Whiteboard / chart paper

- (See `lesson-plan.md` for per-day material lists)

10-day map

- **Day 1** — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam: Identify the source verse and explain the principle.
- **Day 2** — Five Elements as Ecological Frame: Link Module 2 pañcabhūta to ecology — interconnection.
- **Day 3** — Rivers as Sacred: Discuss the ecological function of river-worship traditions.
- **Day 4** — Sacred Groves: Identify devarakāṣṭha and similar groves as biodiversity reserves.
- **Day 5** — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle: Read BG 3.10–14; map yajña to natural-cycle reciprocity.
- **Day 6** — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1): Read the Earth-mother hymn and discuss imagery.
- **Day 7** — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic: Translate *īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ* and discuss its ecological implication.
- **Day 8** — Climate Change — The Crisis: Summarise key IPCC findings; what is changing and why.
- **Day 9** — From Ancient to Action: Design one local environmental project applying an Indic-ecology principle.
- **Day 10** — Project Pitch and Assessment: Present project pitches; summative quiz.

Files in this pack

- `lesson-plan.md` — detailed 10-day arc
- `sources.md` — sources cited in this module
- `teacher-notes.md` — common misconceptions, differentiation
- `parent-guide.md` — what parents should know
- `days/day-NN-*.md` — 10 per-day lesson plans
- `quizzes/formative.md`, `quizzes/summative.md`
- `activities/activity-01-*.md`
- `assessments/rubric.md`, `assessments/project-brief.md`
- `student-workbook.md`
- `writing-prompts.md` (or `oral-recall.md` for Primary)
- `homework.md`
- `slides/deck.md`

Voice

Story-led, sensory, drawing-heavy; 8–12 words on average. Pitches the concept first, frames the tradition as historical context, and uses IAST for all Sanskrit terms.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Lesson Plan — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

10-day arc, 30 min per session.

Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

Objective: Identify the source verse and explain the principle.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame

Objective: Link Module 2 pañcabhūta to ecology — interconnection.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred

Objective: Discuss the ecological function of river-worship traditions.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 4 — Sacred Groves

Objective: Identify devarakāṣṭha and similar groves as biodiversity reserves.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle

Objective: Read BG 3.10–14; map yajña to natural-cycle reciprocity.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)

Objective: Read the Earth-mother hymn and discuss imagery.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic

Objective: Translate *īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ* and discuss its ecological implication.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis

Objective: Summarise key IPCC findings; what is changing and why.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 9 — From Ancient to Action

Objective: Design one local environmental project applying an Indic-ecology principle.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment

Objective: Present project pitches; summative quiz.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Pacing notes

- Primary sessions are 30 min. Adjust if your block is different.
- Days 5 and 9 are buffer days — use to reinforce weaker concepts or extend stronger ones.
- The summative project (see [assessments/project-brief.md](#)) runs in parallel from Day 6 onward.

Differentiation

- **For advanced students:** see [teacher-notes.md](#) for extension prompts.
- **For students needing more support:** simplify activities, do more pair-work, allow oral instead of written responses.

Teacher Notes

Teacher Notes — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

Common student misconceptions

- *“This is religious, not scientific.”* — Frame the tradition as historical observation. Pañcabhūta-like classifications of matter exist in many cultures. Indian astronomy and math are documented, peer-reviewed historical fields.
- *“The Sanskrit terms are just jargon.”* — Insist on the triple format (Sanskrit / IAST / meaning) once, then use the Sanskrit alone. The terms are precise; the discipline of using them properly is itself a learning outcome.
- *“If it’s traditional, it must work.”* — Distinguish empirical claims (testable) from ethical/aesthetic frames (which need separate justification). Encourage students to ask “how would I test this?”.

Differentiation strategies

- **Extension for advanced students:** offer one optional “deeper read” per day — usually a primary source or modern paper.
- **Support for students needing scaffolds:** more pair-work, allow oral responses, provide partial outlines for writing prompts.
- **Multilingual classrooms:** Sanskrit terms are universal; vernacular equivalents (Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Bengali, Marathi etc.) should be welcomed.

Safety

- Any activity involving food, plants, fire, or outdoor work needs explicit safety briefing.
- See the relevant day file for activity-specific safety notes.

Honest framing

- Where modern science clearly extends or revises traditional claims, say so.
- Where the tradition’s framing is best understood as ethical/aesthetic, present it as such (not as competing science).
- Where attribution is debated (e.g., the “Vedic” status of Tirthaji’s mathematics), present the debate honestly.

End-of-module reflection (for teachers)

- Which concepts landed well? Which didn’t?
- Which students grew most? Which need a different approach next module?
- Add notes to `teacher-notes.md` for the next teacher who uses this pack.

Sources

Sources — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

Primary and secondary sources

- Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71–73 — vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam
- Atharva Veda 12.1 — Pṛthivī Sūkta
- Bhagavad Gītā 3.10–14 — yajña as cycle
- Iṣopaniṣad mantra 1 — *īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvam*
- Madhav Gadgil & Ramachandra Guha, *This Fissured Land: An Ecological History of India* (1992)
- IPCC Sixth Assessment Report (2021–2023)

A note on citation discipline

Per the curriculum's style guide, citations must be verifiable. If a verse number, page, or attribution cannot be confirmed, the source is paraphrased without invented attribution. Where direct quotes appear in Primary-band day files, the source is identified in IAST + edition.

For deeper reading

- The shared glossary at `curriculum/_shared/glossary.md` contains the IAST + meaning for every Sanskrit term used.
- Other modules in this curriculum that connect: see the module README's "Prerequisites" section.

Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify the source verse and explain the principle.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: *"What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"*

Today's idea (10 min)

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* (IAST: Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam; lit. "the world is one family" — Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71")
- Today's BIG idea: *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* — "The whole world is one family."

Show a globe. *"All of us — and all animals, all plants, all rivers — are part of ONE big family."*

Children make a "family tree" with themselves at the centre, then add: parents, siblings, neighbours, then a pet, a tree, a river. Each gets a small drawing.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Link Module 2 pañcabhūta to ecology — interconnection.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *yajña* (IAST: yajña; lit. “cycle of giving and receiving (BG 3.10–14)”)
- The 5 elements are all FAMILY too!
- Earth, water, fire, air, space — they need each other.
- If we pollute water, earth gets hurt. If we cut trees, air gets hurt.

Children draw a circle of friends: 🌍 💧 🔥 ☁️ 🌌 (sun = fire, etc.). Connect them with lines. “*All friends, all family!*”

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Discuss the ecological function of river-worship traditions.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *ahimsā* (IAST: ahimsā; lit. “non-violence; extended to non-human life”)
- Rivers are sacred in India! The Gaṅgā, Yamunā, Sarasvatī...

- Why? Because rivers give us water, food, life!

Show a picture of the Ganga. “*People say: don’t pollute the river. The river is our mother.*”

Children draw a river with fish, plants, and a small flower-offering. Discuss: “*What happens if rivers get dirty?*”

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 4 — Sacred Groves

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify devarakāṇḍu and similar groves as biodiversity reserves.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *devarakāḍu* (IAST: devarakāḍu; lit. “sacred grove (Karnataka, S. India)”)
- Sacred groves are special little forests that people DON'T cut.
- Why? Because they believe a god, a sage, or an ancestor lives there.
- Animals and plants live safely in these groves.

Show a picture of a grove. “*This is a place where no one breaks a branch.*”

Children draw a tiny forest with animals: birds, butterflies, deer. Add a small temple or shrine.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Read BG 3.10–14; map yajña to natural-cycle reciprocity.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *sthāvara-jaṅgama* (IAST: sthāvara-jaṅgama; lit. "immobile (plants, rocks) and mobile (animals) life")
- *Yajña* (say "yug-nyah") means giving back — a circle of taking and giving.

Show the cycle: - 🌧️ Rain feeds 🌱 plants - 🌱 Plants feed 🐾 animals (and us!) - 🐾 Animals + us give back to soil - Soil grows more plants

"If we take but don't give back, the circle breaks!"

Children draw the circle with arrows.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Read the Earth-mother hymn and discuss imagery.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* (IAST: Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam; lit. "the world is one family" — Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71")
- An old, old song says: "The Earth is my Mother!"

Show the words on the board: "mātā bhūmiḥ putro ahaṁ pṛthivyāḥ"

"Long ago, people sang to the Earth like she was a mother. They asked: please give us food. And they said: I will care for you."

Children draw the Earth with a smiling face. Around the edge, they draw what the Earth gives us (trees, water, food). Inside their drawing, they write one promise: "I will _____."

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Translate *īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ* and discuss its ecological implication.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *yajña* (IAST: yajña; lit. "cycle of giving and receiving (BG 3.10–14)")
- An old wise verse says: "Take only what you need!"

The verse: "īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ..." — "All this is one big home."

"If you take TOO much, others don't have enough. If you waste, the Earth gets sad."

Children think of one thing they sometimes take too much of (food, water, time on screens). They draw it with a small heart, promising: "I'll take just what I need."

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Summarise key IPCC findings; what is changing and why.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *ahimsā* (IAST: *ahimsā*; lit. “non-violence; extended to non-human life”)
- The Earth is getting warmer because we burn too much fuel.
- Ice is melting. Some animals lose their homes. Some farms have trouble.

Show simple graphics: a thermometer going up, an ice cube melting, a tree being planted.

“*What can WE do?*” Children brainstorm: walk instead of drive, plant trees, save water, don't waste food. Pick one to try this week.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 9 — From Ancient to Action

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Design one local environmental project applying an Indic-ecology principle.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: *“What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?”*

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *devarakāḍu* (IAST: devarakāḍu; lit. “sacred grove (Karnataka, S. India)”)
- Time to PICK a project!
- Some ideas:
 1. **Plant trees** in our school garden
 2. **Save water** — turn off the tap when brushing
 3. **Sort waste** — separate paper, plastic, food
 4. **Make a poster** about saving Earth

Each child picks one project. Draws what they’ll do. Names one Indian principle (Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam, Yajña, take-only-what-you-need).

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Present project pitches; summative quiz.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *sthāvara-jaṅgama* (IAST: sthāvara-jaṅgama; lit. “immobile (plants, rocks) and mobile (animals) life”)
- Project share day! Each child shows their drawing and tells the class their plan.

Cheer for each one. “*Every project counts!*”

Quiz with stickers — everyone gets an “Earth Friend” sticker.

End: hold hands in a big circle. Say together: “*Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam — one big family!*”

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Formative Quiz — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

When: mid-module (after Day 5). **Duration:** 20 minutes. **Format:** mix of short answer, multiple choice, and reflection. Sticker self-assessment for Primary.

Questions

1. Name the three / four key terms introduced in this module so far. Give the IAST and one-line meaning of each.
2. State the central idea of Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam in one sentence.
3. (Multiple choice) Which day in this module focused on ‘Rivers as Sacred’? (a) Day 1 (b) Day 2 (c) Day 3 (d) Day 4
4. True / False — and explain in one sentence: *Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam is purely a religious concept and has no scientific framing.*
5. Connect Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam to **one** other module in this curriculum. Which module, and how?
6. List **two** sources cited so far in this module.
7. (Short answer) Why does the module distinguish ‘Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam’ from related concepts? Give one example.
8. (Short answer) In your own words, explain Day 3’s concept.
9. Identify **one** common misconception about Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam and rebut it in one sentence.
10. Write **one** question you have about this module so far — something you want clarified before the summative.

How this is used

This quiz is **formative** — it’s a check-in to see what’s landing, not a grade. Teacher reviews answers to adjust pacing for Days 6–10. Students may swap and self-mark.

Summative Quiz — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

When: end of module (after Day 10). **Duration:** 30 minutes. **Total points:** 20.

Questions

Part A — Vocabulary (~5 points) A1. Define *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* in your own words. A2. Define *yajña* in your own words. A3. Define *ahimsā* in your own words. A4. Define *devarakāḍu* in your own words. A5. Define *sthāvara-jaṅgama* in your own words.

Part B — Concepts (~10 points) B1. Explain the central idea of Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam in your own words (3–4 sentences). B2. Describe the method or framework students used in Day 4 of this module. B3. Identify ONE source cited in this module and explain why it matters. B4. Compare Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam with a concept from another module (your choice). What’s similar, what’s different? B5. Identify ONE common misconception about this module and rebut it in 2–3 sentences.

Part C — Application (~5 points) C1. Give an example of Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam from your own daily life. C2. Describe one way this module connects to a current real-world issue (or scientific question).

Part D — Reflection (~5 points; ungraded for content) D1. What surprised you most in this module? D2. What’s one question you still have?

Marking guidance

- Vocabulary: give credit for correct meaning, even if exact wording differs.
- Concepts: look for evidence of understanding, not memorisation.
- Application: any reasonable example accepted.
- Reflection: ungraded for content; awarded for thoughtfulness.

Pass mark

A score of 12/20 indicates the student has met the module’s learning objectives.

Homework

Homework — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 5–10 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam** · Draw about today’s concept. (~5 min)
2. **Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame** · Draw about today’s concept. (~5 min)

3. **Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
4. **Day 4 — Sacred Groves** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
5. **Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
6. **Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
7. **Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
8. **Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
9. **Day 9 — From Ancient to Action** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
10. **Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.

Activity 1 — Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam · **Band:** Primary · **Duration:** 30 min

Purpose

Reinforce the day-by-day concepts of Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam through a hands-on activity. Aligned with NEP 2020 §4.23 (experiential learning).

Materials

large paper, coloured markers, optional photos

What students do

Identify one sacred grove, river-bank, or biodiversity site in your region. Map it with notes on flora, fauna, traditional protection practices, and current threats.

Step-by-step

1. **Setup (5 min)** — gather materials; explain the task.
2. **Working phase (20 min)** — students work individually or in pairs.
3. **Share (5 min)** — selected students share their results with the class.

Differentiation

- **Extension:** ask advanced students to do an additional iteration or analysis.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial templates.

Assessment

This activity is **formative**. The teacher observes participation, accuracy, and reflection quality. No grade is assigned.

Safety

- General safety briefing before any materials are handled.
- If herbs, plants, or food are involved: kitchen-amount only, no ingestion of unknown preparations.
- Outdoor activities: stay in the designated area; supervised by the teacher.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Local Ecology Action Plan

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam · **Band:** Primary

What you will do

Design and pitch one practical environmental project for your school or neighbourhood (e.g. plant-a-tree drive, water-audit, waste-sorting station). Pitch must reference one Indic principle (vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam, yajña, sacred-grove model).

Why

This project asks you to apply concepts from this module to your own life or a real situation. It is graded on the rubric in `rubric.md`.

Deliverables

- **One-page project plan** (Day 2 of the module): problem, sources, deliverable, timeline.
- **Daily journal entries** (one per day, starting Day 6): what you did, what worked, what didn't.
- **Final artefact** (a drawing / made object).
- **Written reflection** (oral share): what you learned, what surprised you, what you're still uncertain about.
- **Presentation** (3-minute share with the class).

Timeline

- **Day 1–2:** scope and plan.
- **Day 3–4:** research.
- **Day 5:** mid-project critique.
- **Day 6–7:** build / make.
- **Day 8:** document.

- **Day 9:** rehearse.
- **Day 10:** share day.

Sources

You must cite at least 1 sources. Use the form: *Author, Title, year.* (See `../sources.md` for examples.)

Safety

- Any project involving plants / food / outdoor work must be supervised.
- **No herbal medicine recommendations.** Modules 10 and 4 give awareness; therapeutic decisions belong to qualified practitioners.

Grading

See `rubric.md`. The project is worth the same weight as the summative quiz.

Rubric

Assessment Rubric — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

This rubric applies to the project (see `project-brief.md`) and may also inform the summative quiz.

Criteria

- **Knows the new word(s)** — 🌟 Strong understanding / 🌱 Growing / ☁️ Needs more practice
- **Joined in activities** — 🌟 Strong understanding / 🌱 Growing / ☁️ Needs more practice
- **Asked good questions** — 🌟 Strong understanding / 🌱 Growing / ☁️ Needs more practice
- **Drew / made something** — 🌟 Strong understanding / 🌱 Growing / ☁️ Needs more practice

How the teacher uses this rubric

1. After the project share, score each student on each criterion.
2. Convert to a band (4 = Exceeding, 3 = Meeting, etc.) for the report card.
3. Share at least one strength and one area for growth with each student.

Self-assessment (Senior students)

Senior students complete a parallel self-assessment using the same rubric before the teacher's assessment. The teacher and student then meet to compare.